

JAMES RUSSO

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SUMMARY

Gameplay and XR developer who ships. Solo-built a mixed reality Quest 3 title running stable 72 FPS in Unity 6, and delivered an ARKit iOS app to a university accessibility program. Unreal Engine (Blueprints), Unity/C#, and SwiftUI, with a design background that carries through to interaction quality and comfort tuning.

SKILLS

- **Game Engines:** Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Unity 6
- **Programming:** C#, JavaScript, Swift/SwiftUI
- **Gameplay & XR:** VR/MR for Meta Quest and Apple Vision Pro; ARKit; hand tracking, passthrough, spatial audio, comfort tuning
- **QA & Optimization:** Usability testing, bug reproduction, regression testing, frame-rate profiling
- **Interaction Design:** User flows, wireframing, rapid prototyping, accessible UI, VR/MR HUDs
- **Web & UI:** HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, jQuery, D3.js, MySQL
- **Tools:** Figma, Blender, Photoshop, Xcode, Visual Studio, Git/GitHub

PROJECTS

Ghost Defiant | Mixed Reality Shooter | Unity 6, Meta Quest 3

2025

- Solo-shipped MR ghost-hunting shooter over an 8-month senior capstone. Built custom debris and impact physics, a spatial audio and fog VFX pipeline tuned for passthrough legibility, and a hand-tracking-first interaction model refined against playtest data. Held stable 72 FPS with full hand tracking and passthrough. Selected for the Boise State senior showcase.

Bookshelf Adventures | AR Reading App | SwiftUI, ARKit

2025

- Owned the ARKit pipeline for an accessible iOS reader built with Mississippi State University's special-needs department: image recognition against physical book pages, runtime 3D model placement, and real-time tracking. Co-designed SwiftUI components from the research team's accessibility findings. Delivered to the partner program for student use.

Unreal Engine Prototypes | Unreal Engine 5

2024 – 2025

- 2D fighter with AI combat logic, animation blueprints, and combo systems. Multiplayer target range built on Unreal's replication system with networked scoring, dynamic spawns, and hit detection.

Student Finance Simulator | Web Application | HTML, CSS, JavaScript

2023

- Lead interaction designer and tester on a live Boise State budgeting tool. Delivered user flows, wireframes, and high-fidelity UI with a three-person team and university financial staff.

EXPERIENCE

Apple Inc. | Boise Towne Square, Boise, ID

Aug 2025 – Present

Technical Specialist, Genius Bar (Jul 2026 – Present) | Specialist (Aug 2025 – Jul 2026)

- Run frontline diagnostics and triage at the Genius Bar, ordering cases by severity across a full appointment queue
- Troubleshoot hardware and software failures across iOS and macOS, communicating root cause and resolution to customers at every technical skill level
- Document case history and coordinate escalations to the hardware repair team

EDUCATION

B.S., Games, Interactive Media & Mobile Technologies | Boise State University, Boise, ID | Aug 2021 to Dec 2025

CERTIFICATES

- **XR Developer, Program Certificate** | Boise State University, GIMM (May 2025)
- **Unreal Engine Fundamentals** | Epic Games (April 2026)
- **Apple Certified Support Technician (ACST)** | Apple (July 2026)